

It took Google only a few years to become a household name. From web searches to email, their synonymity with the online world grew exponentially with numerous innovations and acquisitions. And even as the world holds its breath in anticipation for the famed Google Glass product, the engineers over at the Googleplex are more giddy than ever about Chrome OS. Why is that?

Isn't Chrome OS just a browser interface that only works when you're connected to the internet? Isn't it just useful to connect all your Google services under one umbrella? Sure, it makes your Google experience better but do we really need to consider it an "operating system" and pay for a lightweight Chromebook that can't even game? Well, the answer to all those is yes. But there's so much more.

So, what is it?

Chrome OS is an open source operating system designed by Google as a lightweight web based client. The operating system is ideal for netbooks, tablet PCs and out-dated hardware systems that have become obsolete. It's key utilities are based on the internet and rely on an active web interface to accomplish its major tasks. All data is intended to be stored in cloud servers and applications can be either web based or run locally on machines.

The most unique feature of the Chrome OS is its much touted seven second boot up time which is possible due to its streamlined design, that reworks the traditional system architecture of an operating system and hardware relationship. The operating system is designed to be run on Intel x86 and ARM processor chips. At its purest state Chrome OS has only one locally run application which is the browser and is integral to the operating system interface. Both the browser and OS are set up to be auto-upgraded from Google's servers in a seamless manner adding new updates and features.

